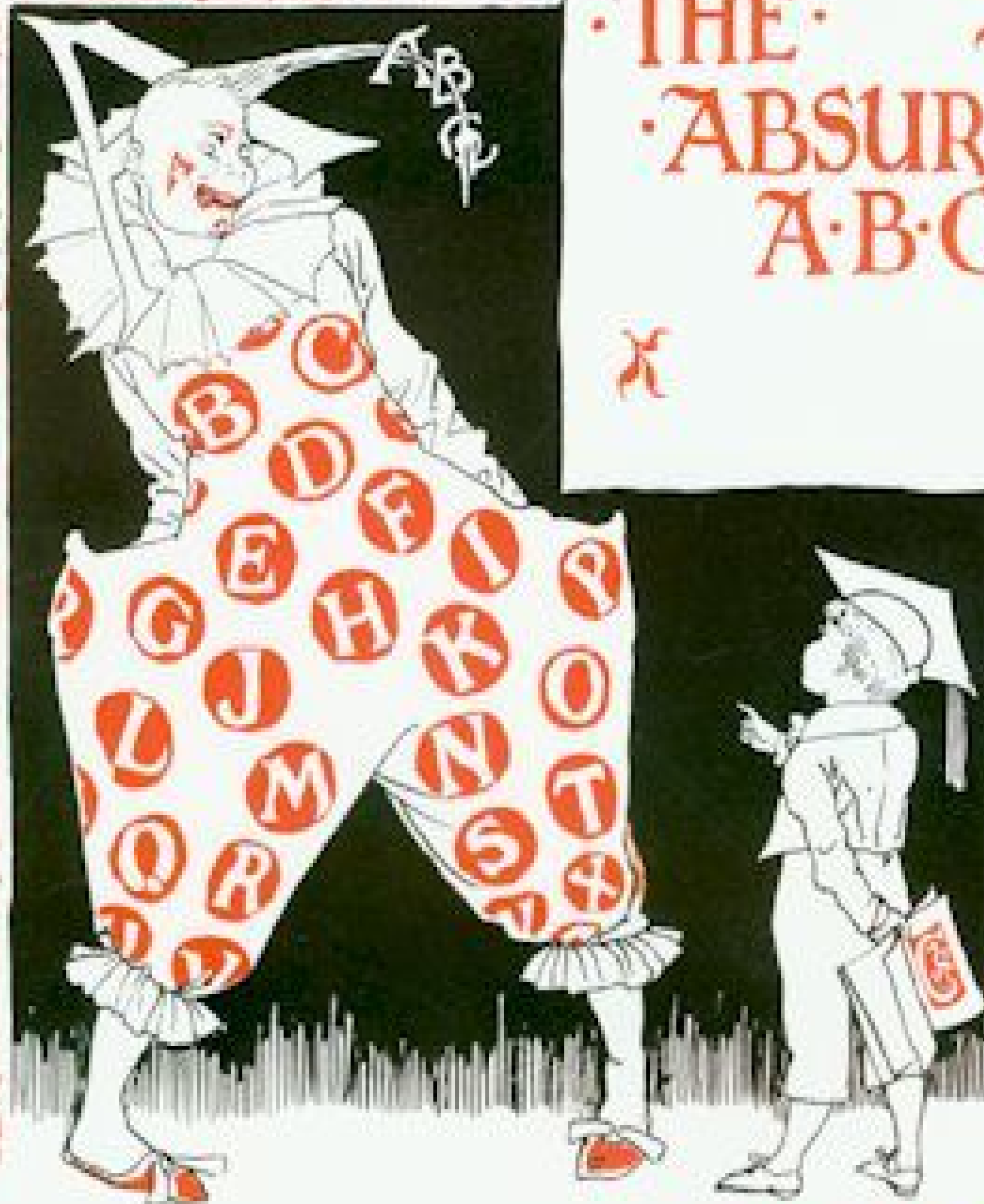


WALTER CRANE'S
PICTURE BOOKS
RE-ISSUE

THE ABSURD A·B·C



JOHN LANE
THE BODLEY HEAD
LONDON & NEW
YORK

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PICTURE BOOKS
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Revised and enlarged



THE ABSURD A·B·C

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THE BODLEY HEAD,
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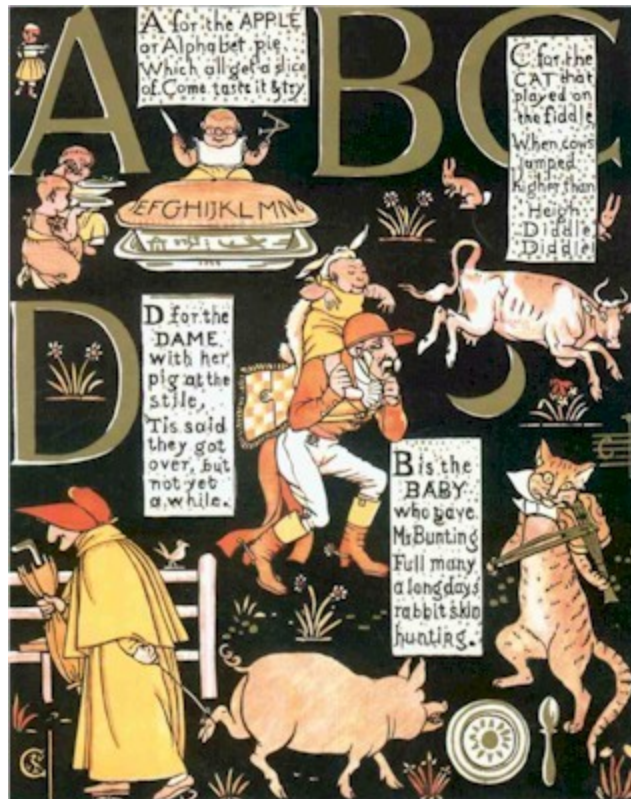


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The absurd ABC originally published 1874.



A for the APPLE
 or Alphabet pie,
 Which all get a slice of.
 Come taste it & try.

B is the BABY
 who gave Mr Bunting
 Full many a long day's
 rabbit skin hunting.

C for the CAT
 that played on the fiddle,
 When cows jumped higher than
 'Heigh Diddle Diddle!'

D for the DAME

with her pig at the stile,
'Tis said they got over,
but not yet a while.



E for the Englishman,
ready to make fast
The giant who wanted to
have him for breakfast.

F for the Frog in the story
you know,
Begun with a wooing but
ending in woe.

G for Goosey Gander
who wandered upstairs,
And met the old man

who objected to prayers.



H for poor Humpty who
after his fall,
Felt obliged to resign his
seat on the wall.

I for the Inn where they
wouldn't give beer,
To one with too much
and no money, I fear.

J does for poor Jack and
also for Jill,
Who had so disastrous
a tumble down hill.



K for calm Kitty, at dinner
 who sat,
 While all the good folks
 watched the dog & the cat.

L for Little man, gun and
 bullets complete,
 Who shot the poor duck, and
 was proud of the feat.

M for Miss Muffet, with
 that horrid spider,
 Just dropped into tea and
 a chat beside her.

N for the Numerous children
 they who
 Were often too much for
 their mother in Shoe.

O the Old person that

cobwebs did spy,
And went up to sweep 'em
Oh ever so high!

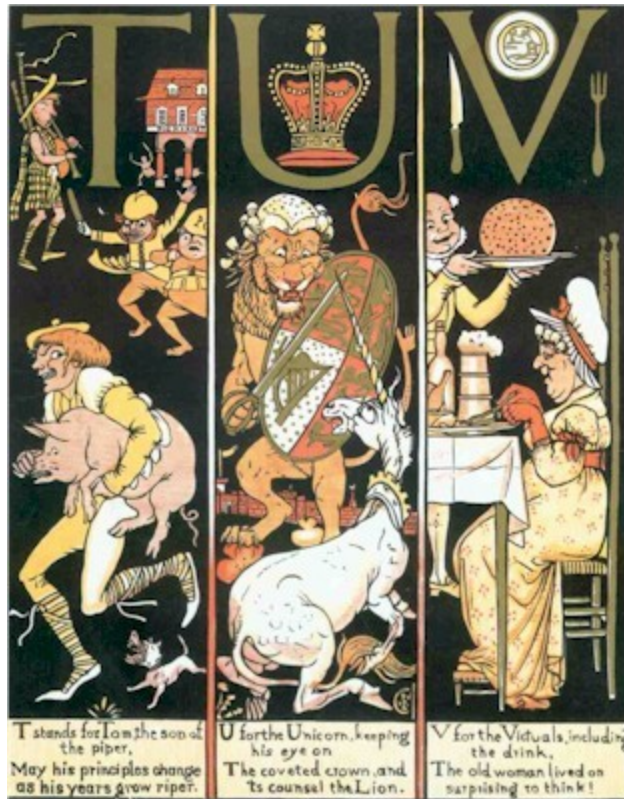
P for the Pie made of
blackbirds to sing,
A song fit for supper
a dish for a king.



Q for Queen Anne
who sat in the sun
Till she, more than the lily
resembled the bun

R stands for Richard &
Robert, those men
Who didn't get up one
fine morning till ten!

S for the Snail that showed
wonderful fight,
Putting no less than twenty-four
tailors to flight!

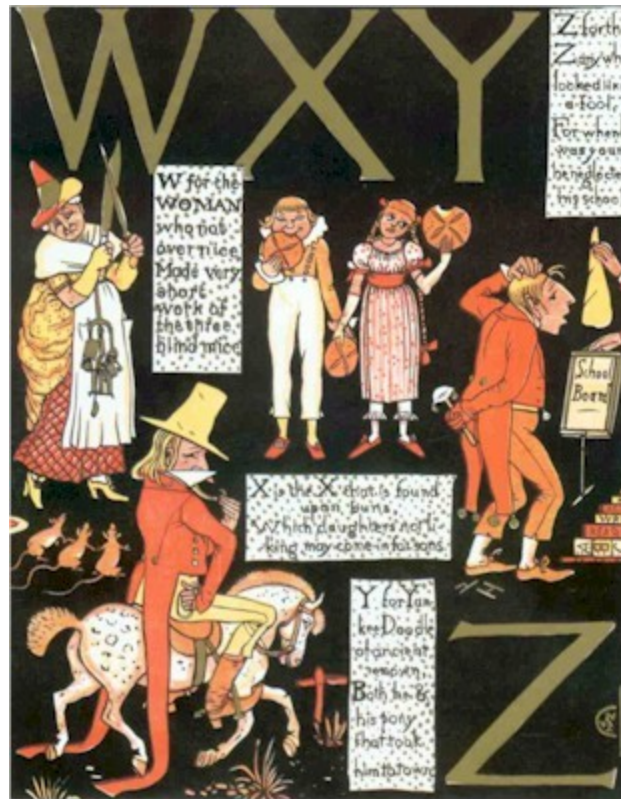


T stands for Tom, the son of
the piper,
May his principles change
as his years grow riper.

U for the Unicorn, keeping

his eye on
The coveted crown, and
'ts counsel the Lion.

V for the Victuals, including
the drink,
The old woman lived on
surprising to think!



W for the WOMAN
who not over nice,
Made very short work
of the three blind mice.

X is the X
that is found upon buns,
Which, daughters not liking,

may come in for sons.

Y for Yankee Doodle
of ancient renown,
Both he & his pony
that took him to town.

Z for the Zany who
looked like a fool,
For when he was young
he neglected his school.





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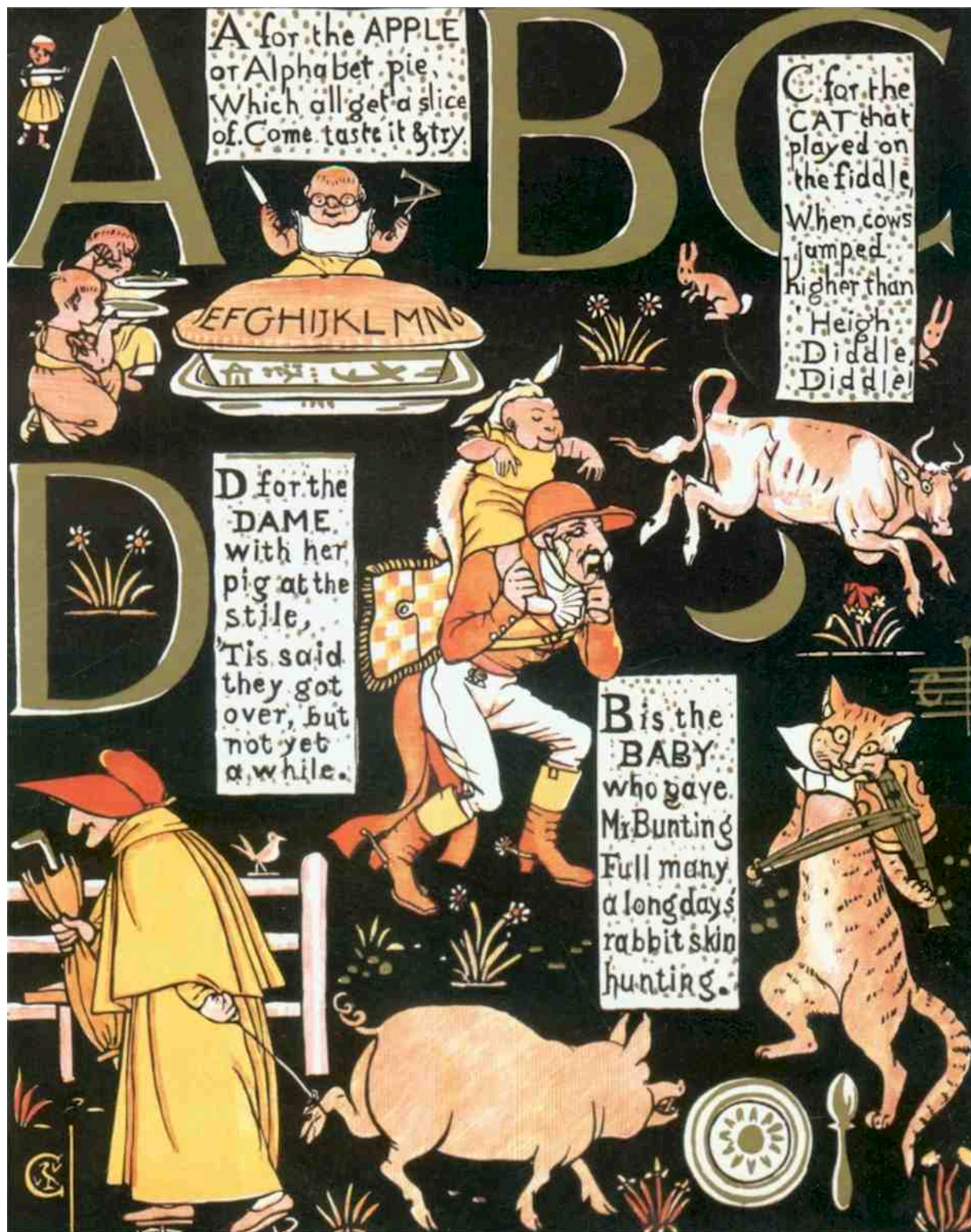
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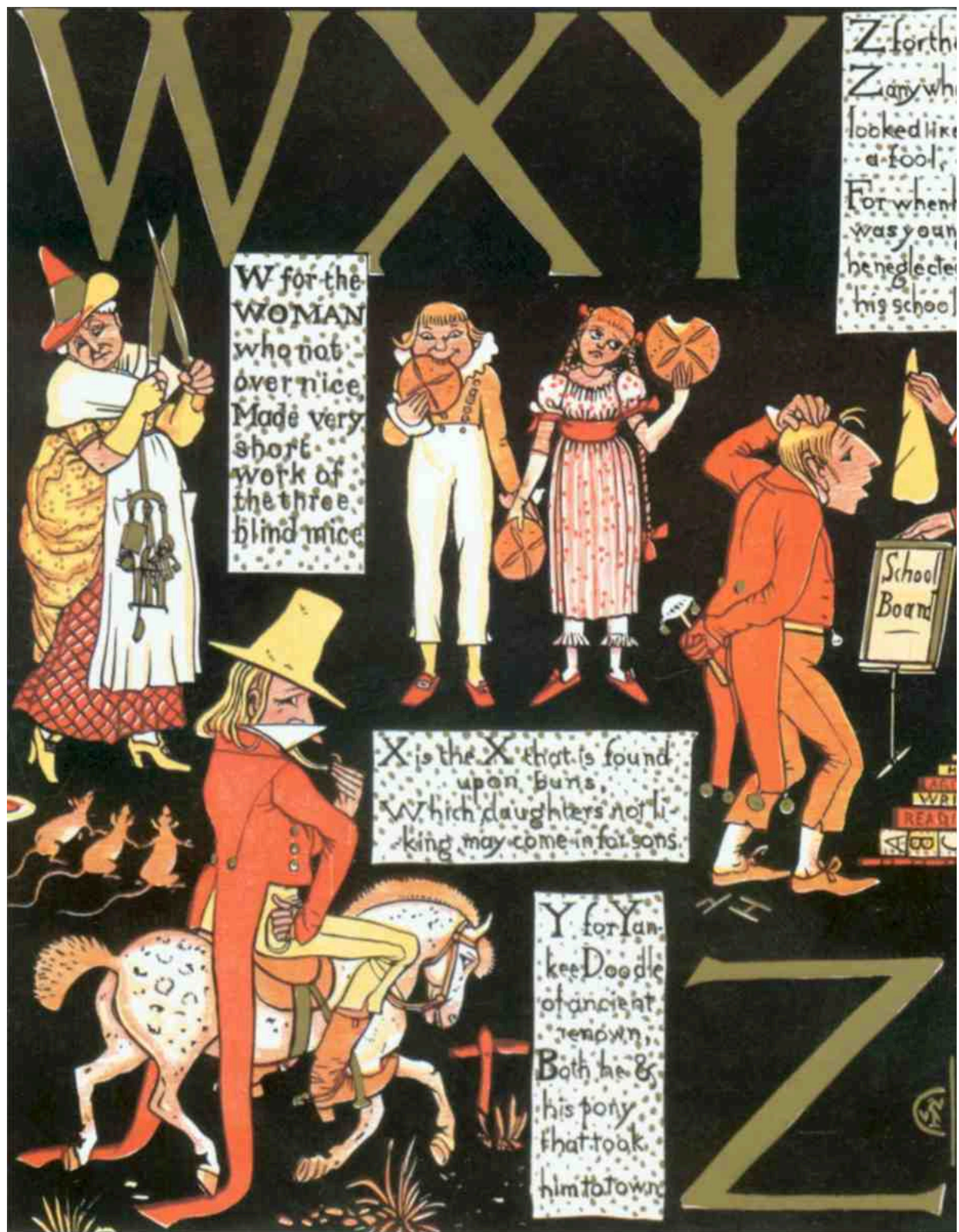
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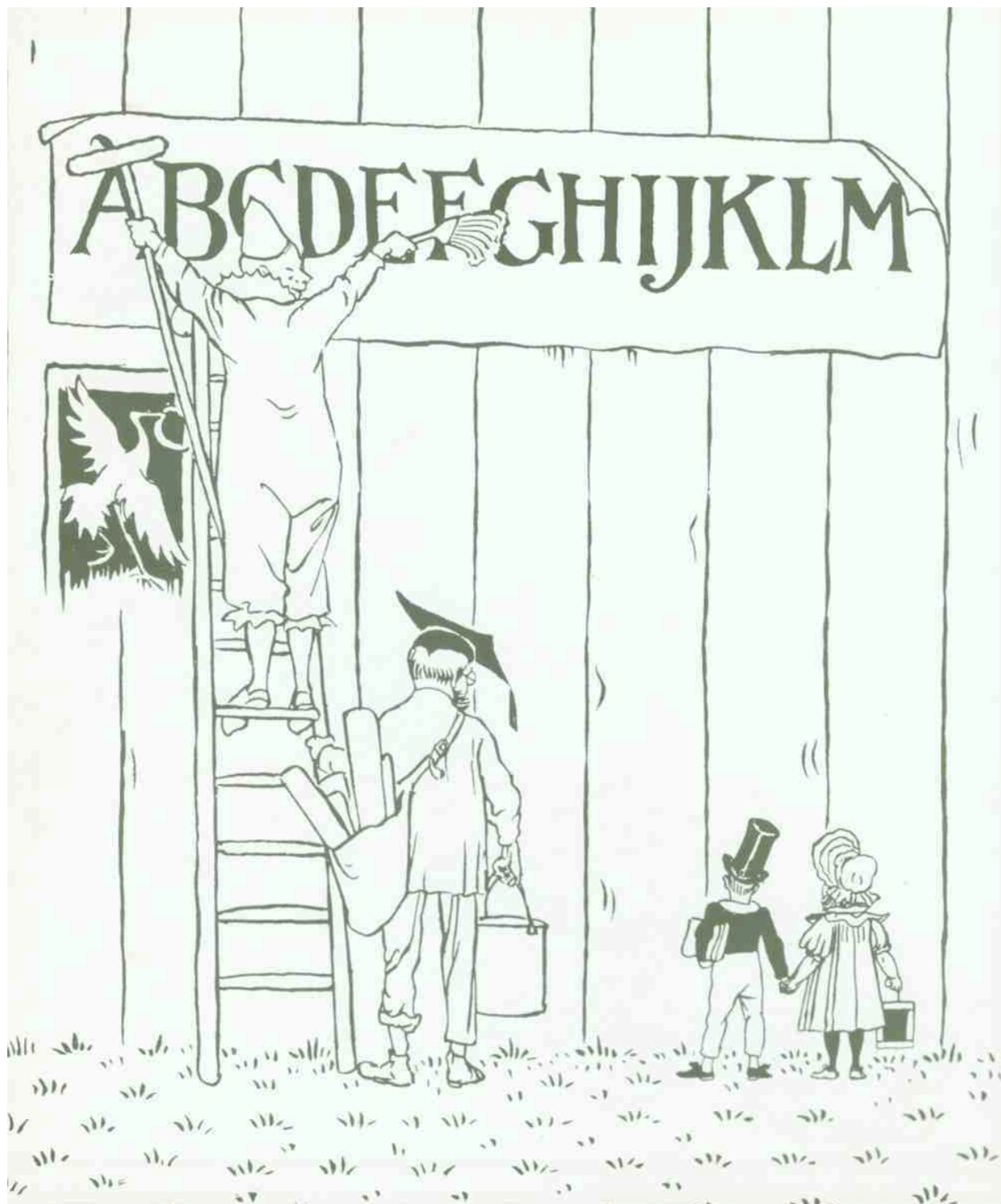
U for the Unicorn, keeping
his eye on
The coveted crown, and
'ts counsel the Lion.



V for the Victuals, including
the drink,
The old woman lived on
surprising to think!



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